# ONCE

## A Media Venture Studio and Arts Collective

Giving the future a world to inhabit, a story to follow, and a culture through which to become real.



ALEX KENNEDY

# The Future in Our Imagination

Culture takes direction through the futures it can imagine: the stories, characters and ways of living that make another civilisation conceivable.

ONCE renders detailed, believable positive futures, laden with archetypal meaning, discernible truths and characters that speak to what the culture cannot currently see.

The purpose is activation. To renew the relationship between humanity, nature and spirit, and give that renewal a form we can begin to live.



# The Creative Force Behind a Renaissance

ONCE convenes filmmakers, philosophers, systems thinkers and technologists working at the frontier of cultural change. Their combined knowledge spans regenerative economics, psychology, emerging technology and the forms of culture that hold a civilisation together.

The studio concentrates that intelligence into narrative worlds, films and live experiments, giving ambitious ideas the creative infrastructure, collaborators and patronage to enter public imagination.



# A New Scale of Creative Production

My years in VFX revealed the cost and effort of creating images of wonder. AI opens an entirely new way to expand creativity across the visual form.

The opportunity is to compress a full-scale production crew into the essential creatives who direct an AI-powered pipeline, pursuing the visual ambition and emotional craft of a Pixar film.

That puts far more of the production within reach of the artists carrying the stories society needs to hear.



# A Future Seen from Within



Our narrative world inhabits a later cycle of civilisation, closer to the great attractor, where today's crises have become history.

Its characters live within the cultures and technologies we are working towards. Their conflicts carry lessons from our own experiments.

Through desire, consequence and identification, an audience feels how another world works. The story gives its ideas emotional weight and a life beyond the argument.



# The Craft and Fieldwork Behind It

Alex Kennedy, founder and creative director

Five years in visual effects across studios including Method, One of Us and Aardman.

Coliving projects and residencies in Berlin and Guatemala. Startup consulting, branding, narrative strategy and crowdfunding films. Recorded experiments in group sense-making and exponential coordination, with insights captured on cards and recombined into concepts, ventures and stories.

# Where Idealism Meets Human Nature

The Cognitive Fusion Reactor brought frontier thinkers into a live experiment in coliving, sense-making and creative coordination. The cameras caught the breakthroughs, then the friction, conflict and drama as idealism met ego, power and human limits.

The residency ended in a break with my cofounder and produced the most consequential lessons of the experiment. That recorded story now anchors the docu-series: the dynamics of a small creative group revealing the challenges that recur across communities, organisations and movements.



# From the Room into the Culture

**CAPTURE**

Residency dialogue, conflict and discovery

**CONDENSE**

Cards, recorded context and narrative structures

**CREATE**

Documentary episodes and fictional worlds

**ACTIVATE**

Artists, researchers and patrons enter the work



A live conversation becomes recorded context. Its insights are distilled onto cards, recombined into narrative structures and developed into films.

The films direct resonant artists, researchers and patrons towards the studio, where they contribute expertise, resources and further experience to the next cycle.

# Build the Ark Starting with the Cockpit

The cockpit joins archive retrieval, research, AI production and communication around the demands of one creator. Agents carry context between these functions, keeping contributors connected to the decisions, source material and creative process.

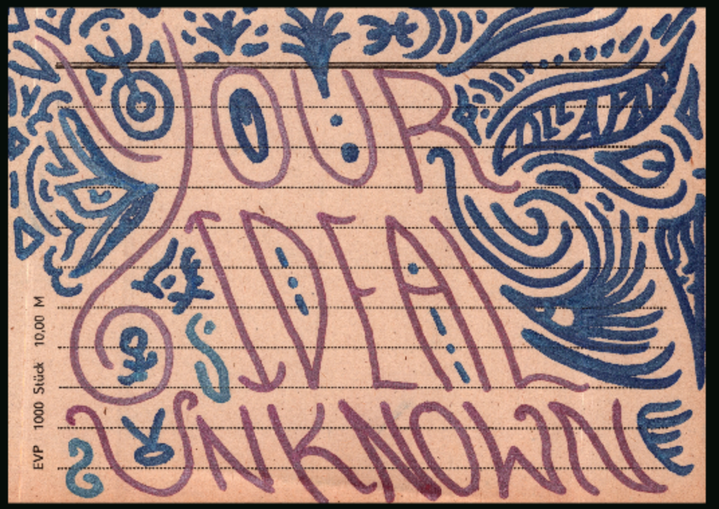
The studio will demonstrate this unique pipeline in full operation, with its films revealing the capacity of the tools behind them. The workflows will then be made available to creators and organisations building their own sovereign working environments.



# The Studio’s Economic Engine

Commissioned films, narrative strategy and creative consulting generate income from capabilities the studio is developing for its own work. Original productions build a catalogue of stories, worlds and intellectual property, extending into media releases, experiences and future licensing.

Patronage supplies the time, tools and creative continuity to establish that catalogue before it can earn its own income. It funds the research and experimentation from which the studio’s distinctive work emerges, with patrons receiving cards, access and ongoing recognition as that work develops.



# Where Fiction Enters Culture

Screenings, salons and residencies bring filmmakers, researchers, founders and patrons into the worlds the films introduce. Together they test the cultural practices, relationships and technologies those worlds contain.

Live dialogue is captured, distilled into cards and returned to the room for further interpretation. The insights feed the next production; the production draws further collaborators into the studio. Fiction and shared practice develop each other.



# Contribution Becomes Access

A patron funds an edit. A collaborator gives a month of research. A host offers a room in which the next experiment begins. Each contribution carries a history and creates further capacity for the studio.

Cards recognise that contribution and return value through access to the work, knowledge, network and experiences it enables. My commitment is to keep cardholders connected to what I create, carrying their early belief forward into the studio’s future.



# A Card Opens into a World

A physical card condenses an idea, a contribution or a shared experience. Its provenance connects the holder to the moment it was created and the work it helped bring into being.

A photograph of the card will become an access key to its recorded context in the Arkhive. That connection opens the relevant films, conversations and offers, allowing recognition and access to travel as the card is gifted through the network.





# Patronage That Continues to Give

Patrons give the studio time, tools and creative freedom. Their cards remain integral to what follows, connecting that contribution to the films, knowledge, relationships and experiences produced with it.

Reciprocity develops with the studio: access to the creative process, introductions across the network, curated gatherings and new work. Cards can be passed onward, carrying that recognition to further contributors. The commitment is to keep finding meaningful ways to honour the belief that made the work possible.

# Studio, Academy, Monastery

The studio will establish the creative and economic centre of a wider cultural institution. Its films and worlds will draw the talent, attention and resources that carry the next structures into being.

The Academy will develop leadership through real projects and responsibility. The Monastery will provide space for integration, ritual and spiritual practice.

Together they will support a network of residencies and creative spaces where storytelling, learning and culture develop as one continuous practice.



# The Cognitive Fusion Reactor

The story is selected and the experience recorded. The next phase turns the Cognitive Fusion Reactor into a docu-series and establishes the production environment for the worlds that follow.

## 01

EQUIP

Gather the tools and define the workflow for sustained creative production.

## 02

PRODUCE

Shape the recorded material into the series: narrative, edit, sound and visual treatment.

## 03

RELEASE

Publish across channels. Make the website the access point for the story, archive and participation.

# Backing the Next Phase

The next phase establishes the studio’s production capacity: the Cognitive Fusion Reactor docu-series, the tools and workflows behind it, and a place for the next creative experiments.

## £20,000

The Ask

Equip the production environment, develop the docu-series and begin releasing across channels, with the website presenting the story in depth.

## £40,000

The Ideal Level

Initiate the studio space, host events and produce films, while building production capacity and the creative process for novel intellectual property.

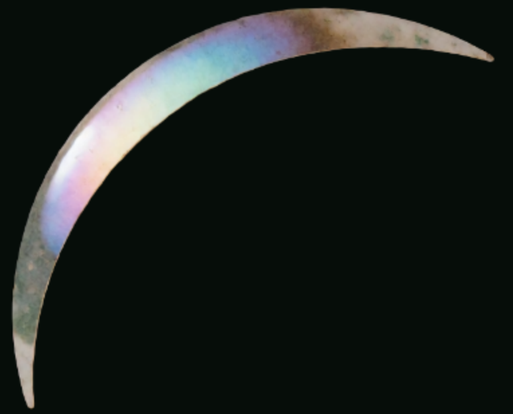
# Help Design the Future We Inhabit

I’m bringing together filmmakers, researchers, technologists and cultural thinkers to imagine the future we want to live in, develop its storylines and construct the details of its worlds.

The studio will host the minds best suited to this task: researching the cultures that sustain life, developing the production workflows, and giving narrative form to the lessons the West needs to receive and integrate.

Back the studio, bring your craft, or connect us to the collaborators and spaces that will carry this work into the world.

Alex Kennedy
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ONCE

# Five Coordinates of the Work

A way to read the same project at different scales.



## Root

The inputs and forces that set change in motion



## Square

Boundaries and systems that give the work form



## Circle

The living process of culture and shared practice



## Triangle

Direction, attention and the discipline of orientation



## Star

The north star and great attractor: the future we serve

# The Orbital Ark

The Orbital Ark is the shared environment for navigating ONCE's worlds, relationships and recorded memory. Cards will connect physical encounters to media held in the Arkhive, demonstrating how cultural participation and data sovereignty work together.

## 01

### THE CARD

A physical key linking a contribution, encounter or idea to its recorded context.

## 02

### THE ARKHIVE

Films, dialogue and creative material held with the permissions that govern access.

## 03

### THE ORBITAL ARK

An interface for exploring the connections and sharing media through a network of trust.

# A World Held in a Hand

The cards carry our commitment to recognise those who help this future take form. They remain part of everything we create, with access, exchange and reciprocity developing alongside the studio.

We are writing future history through the films, artefacts and cultures we make together. What begins as a contribution enters the story, and what we make of that story is the work ahead.

